

KENTUCKY OWNER-BUILDER PERMIT KIT

Find out who inspects · File the three state permits · Pass the inspections

Project Address: _____

City / Town: _____

County: _____

Local Building Department: _____

Owner-Builder: _____

Permit Application Date: _____

If your city or county has no building permit ordinance, write NONE — and read KY.1.

Every Kentucky statute, threshold, and requirement in this kit
is cited on the page it appears on — verified August 2026.

BUILD YOUR HOUSE

build-your-house.com

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How to Use This Kit

Five working documents, from "who is actually going to inspect this?" to the certificate of occupancy.

Kentucky is one of the easiest states in the country to build your own home in, and one of the easiest to get badly wrong. There is **no state general contractor license** to be exempt from, and the statute lets a homeowner do their own wiring in one flat sentence with no conditions attached to it.

The part nobody tells you is this. Kentucky writes **one mandatory residential code** that binds every house in the state — and then makes the **building permit, the inspections and the certificate of occupancy optional** unless your city or county passed an ordinance requiring them. The state is then **forbidden by statute** from stepping in on a single-family dwelling. So in much of Kentucky the code legally governs your house and *no building official will ever look at it*.

That does not mean nothing applies. Three things apply everywhere, and they are the ones that stop your build cold: a **state plumbing permit** from Frankfort, an **electrical certificate of approval** your power company needs before it will connect you, and a **health department septic permit** that has to be in hand before the state will even take your plumbing application. This kit separates the three from the optional part, and cites both.

WHAT IS IN THE KIT

The five documents

	Document	What it does for you
KY.1	Owner-Builder Exemption Walkthrough	What you may do yourself, trade by trade, and the one question that changes everything: does your jurisdiction require a permit? Read this first.
KY.2	Permit Application Checklist	What to gather before you file — the state plumbing permit, the septic approval that gates it, the workers' compensation affidavit, code editions and fees.
KY.3	Inspection Sequence	The order inspections happen in, who calls each one when there is no building department, and fields for dates and results.
KY.4	Where to File Directory	How to find out whether your county has an ordinance at all, and a page to write down every office you confirmed.
KY.5	Forms & Documents Index	Each document you will meet: what it is, when, and from where.

HOW TO USE IT

- **Start with KY.1.** Its first section settles whether a building permit exists where you are building. Nothing else in the kit sequences correctly until you know.
- **Then call the health department** — the septic permit is the longest pole on a rural Kentucky build, and by statute it has to be in hand before your state plumbing application will be accepted.
- **Work KY.2 with a pen.** The permits that always apply are worth more attention than the one that might not.
- **Keep KY.3 on the job** and record every inspection as it happens — especially if nobody is required to inspect you.

How these facts were checked — and what this is not

Every Kentucky claim here was read against its primary source in August 2026 — the Revised Statutes and the Administrative Regulations at apps.legislature.ky.gov, and the Department of Housing, Buildings and Construction's own pages — and is cited where it appears. Where the answer genuinely depends on your local ordinance, the kit says so and gives you a line to write what you confirmed. Not legal advice.